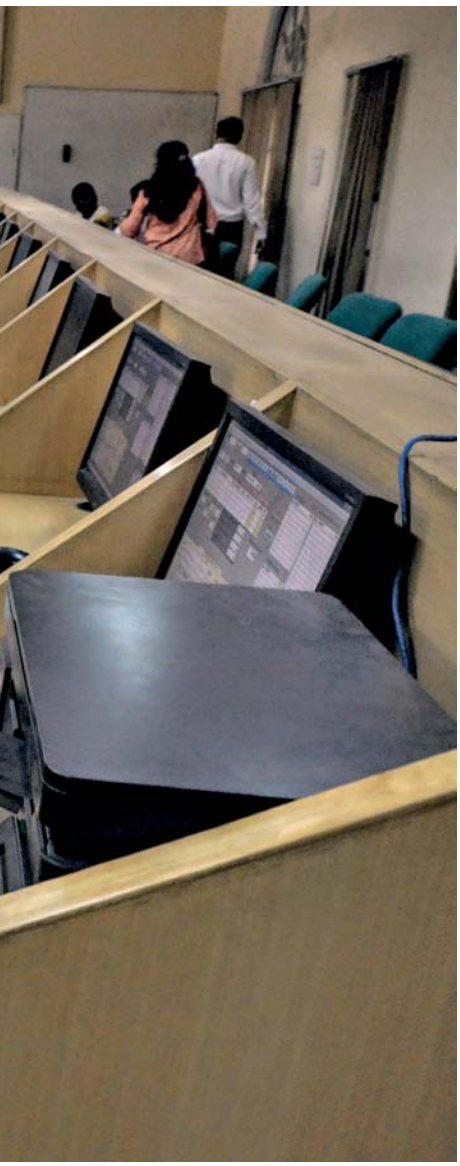


ANI

WHAT'S CUET?

A quick guide to college admission under central universities

- Common University Entrance Test (CUET) is a common test for admission into undergraduate courses offered by 45 central universities. Admissions will be based on CUET scores and not 10+2 board results
- Conducted by the National Testing Agency (NTA), the test will comprise multiple-choice questions
- The syllabus will be NCERT curriculum for Class XII
- There will be negative marking for wrong answers
- It will have three broad segments—a language test in one of 13 languages, a subject test in a maximum of six out of a list of 27, and a general test to examine aptitude, logic and reasoning
- For students willing to pursue a language course, there will be another test on a language from a list of 19
- The first CUET will be held in July and is mandatory for admission to all central universities

Come May and every aspirant to an undergraduate course in the Delhi University student starts losing their sleep over the impossibly high cut-offs for admission into a college and course of their choice. Not this academic session. This summer, nearly 180,000 students will get admission to undergraduate courses in the Delhi University and 44 other central universities based not on marks in the 10+2 board exams, but on the basis of the score in the Common Universities Entrance Test (CUET). "It's mandatory for all central universities," says Professor M. Jagadesh Kumar, chairman of the University Grants Commission (UGC). "We believe once they see merit in this test, state universities and deemed universities too will soon adopt it for admissions."

To be conducted by the National Testing Agency (NTA), a central government agency established in 2017, the computer-based examination will comprise multiple-choice questions for assessing language abilities, knowledge of various subjects and general aptitude. While each correct answer will get the student one mark, there will be negative marking (1/4th of the marks allotted) for wrong answers. As per the details given out by the agency, CUET will be divided into three broad segments. The first, a test of language, will have two parts, 1A and 1B. In 1A, mandatory for all, every student will have to choose a language from 13—English, Hindi, Assamese, Bengali, Gujarati, Kannada, Malayalam, Marathi, Odia, Tamil, Telugu, Urdu and Punjabi. The optional 1B is only for those who want to take up undergraduate courses in languages and offers a choice of 19 languages—Arabic, Chinese, French, German, Italian, Japanese, Nepali, Persian, Russian, Spanish, Tibetan, Bodo, Dogri, Kashmiri, Konkani, Maithili, Manipuri, Santhali and Sindhi. In both 1A and 1B, students will be tested for literary aptitude and vocabulary through reading comprehension of different types of passages—factual, literary and narrative. They will have to attempt at least 40 of the total 50 questions in 45 minutes.

The second segment will be a domain-specific paper. A student can take the test in a maximum of six subjects from a list of 27 *(see CUET Format)*. The number of subjects a student chooses will depend on the choice of courses and universities—the more courses one applies for, the more subjects one will be tested in. This, too, will be a 45-minute test in which students will have to attempt at least 40 out of 50 questions.

The domain-specific test is designed to evaluate a student's aptitude for pursuing an undergraduate course in the chosen subject. Though it can be taken only in a subject one has studied in Class XII, that won't stop